

ENG517

Mid-Term

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

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Define CALL

"The search for and study of applications of the computer in language teaching and learning." – Levy (1997)

Approaches of CALL

1. **Behavioristic CALL** – drill & practice (1950s–70s)
2. **Communicative CALL** – communicative exercises (1970s–80s)
3. **Integrative CALL** – multimedia + internet (1990s–today)

Applications of CALL (5 examples)

- Word processing
- Tutorials/drills
- Games
- Simulations (e.g., "A la rencontre de Philippe")
- Internet tools like email & chat

Characteristics of CALL

- Learner-controlled pacing
- Interactivity
- Feedback-rich
- Use of multimedia (text/audio/video)
- Emphasis on both form and meaning

Principles and Implications of CALL

- Encourages autonomous learning
- Tailors content to cognitive style & pace
- Offers interactive environments with immediate feedback
- Not a replacement for teachers, but a strong supplement

CALL as a Distinct Field

- Gained identity in the 1980s with rise of PCs
- Supported by professional organizations (e.g., CALICO)
- Draws on linguistics, SLA, HCI, AI, and education

Model of CALL

Based on **Dunkin & Biddle's model**:

- **Presage** (teacher/learner background)
- **Context** (physical & institutional setting)

- **Process** (learning tasks, interaction)
- **Product** (learning outcomes)

Aim of CALL

- To explore and implement ways computers can aid language learning through interaction, tools, and practice

Emergence of CALL

- Became distinct in the 1980s with personal computers
- Early CALL existed in mainframe settings like Stanford & MIT (PLATO project)

How can CALL be used to effectively teach language?

- Offers multimedia-rich environments
- Enables individualized learning paths
- Supports real-time communication (chat, forums)
- Encourages learner autonomy
- Provides consistent and adaptive feedback

Five Types of Optimal Input in CALL

1. Comprehensible
2. Interesting and relevant
3. Not overly simplified
4. Ample in quantity
5. Tailored to learner's proficiency level ("learner fit")

Concept of "Learner Fit" in CALL

Materials and tasks should suit the learner's language level, interests, and learning style to optimize acquisition

5 Ways to Establish a CALL Environment

1. Install multimedia-equipped computers
2. Provide internet access
3. Use virtual learning platforms
4. Train teachers in CALL tools
5. Support student autonomy in labs or BYOD settings

Problems in Developing CALL Programs (3 major)

1. Lack of funds
2. Lack of technical and pedagogical expertise

3. Lack of appropriate authoring tools

Difficulties in Creating CALL Models

- CALL spans many variables and technologies
- Rapid tech changes make universal models hard
- Needs to account for both in-class and self-study contexts

Lack of Funding Affecting CALL

- Slows development of tailored CALL content
- Pushes reliance on commercial software
- Limits access to hardware and training

Judgmental Evaluation of CALL

- Based on checklists, rubrics, and expert reviews
- Considers usability, engagement, and content quality

Empirical Evaluation of CALL (3 questions on learner fit)

1. Does the task prompt negotiation of meaning?
2. Does the learner receive comprehensible input?
3. Is the output meaningful and context-rich?

How CALL Helps Overcome Shyness in Speaking

- Allows private practice with no social pressure
- Speech recognition provides non-judgmental feedback
- Reduces fear of making mistakes in front of others

Educational Games in CALL

- Make learning engaging and meaningful
- Promote problem-solving
- Provide disguised repetition of target forms

Relationship Between Science Fiction and CALL

- SF-inspired technologies (avatars, virtual worlds) now used in CALL (e.g., Second Life)
- Vision of immersive, AI-driven learning now partly realized

Behaviorist Models in CALL

- Emphasize drill, repetition, reward/punishment
- CALL programs reinforce correct responses through grades/scores

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Constructivism in CALL (5–6 lines)

Learners build knowledge by interacting with content and peers. CALL supports this through exploratory environments, projects, and social tasks. Constructivist CALL emphasizes meaning, context, and collaboration

Collaboration in Behaviorism vs. Constructivism

- **Behaviorism**: Individual learning, fixed answers
- **Constructivism**: Peer interaction, negotiation of meaning, co-construction of knowledge

Comprehensible Input (Rod Ellis)

Language input must be understandable but slightly above the learner's current level. Negotiation of meaning during interaction enhances comprehension

Note on Learner Characteristics

- **Age**: Younger learners may need more visuals and interactivity
- **Cognitive ability**: Affects how learners process and retain CALL content
- **Computer experience**: Influences task navigation and confidence

What is a virus? (Brief note)

A **virus** is a malicious program that can destroy files, slow performance, or replicate itself. It often arrives via email attachments or downloaded software and requires user activation. Some viruses spread through a user's email contact list, and newer ones (e.g., Storm Worm) exploit security loopholes.

5 Advantages of Using Hypertext

1. Traces links forward/backward for references
2. Same section can be reused without rewriting
3. Hypertext appears alongside main text (no flipping pages)
4. Helps learners build schema
5. Encourages collaboration through authoring features

Note on CAT (Computerized Adaptive Testing)

CAT adjusts test item difficulty based on learner responses: correct → harder item, incorrect → easier. Benefits include individualized testing and test security. However, setup is complex and learners can't review previous answers.

Compilation

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Define Empirical Evaluation

Empirical evaluation involves collecting observable data (e.g., learner interactions, outcomes) to evaluate CALL effectiveness. It contrasts with judgmental evaluation, which uses expert opinions or checklists.

Educational Objectives/Applications of CALL

- Promote language learning via tutor and tool roles
- Support reading, writing, listening, and speaking
- Offer individual pacing and learning strategies
- Foster interaction through multimedia and internet tools (e.g., email, games, chat)

Silent Features of Voice Apps for Language Learning

Voice-enabled CALL tools offer:

- Immediate feedback
- Error correction
- Practice without social anxiety
- Repetition and self-paced speaking

Simultaneity

Simultaneity refers to the ability to access and interact with multiple elements (e.g., hypertext, audio, video) at once, enhancing learning by allowing parallel processing of language input.

Analysis of Text

Text analysis in CALL involves tools like concordancers and corpora that help learners identify patterns, structures, and vocabulary use for language learning and writing improvement.

Technological tools

- **Multimedia / Hyper- & hypermedia** – non-linear mix of text-audio-video for exploratory learning
- **HyperCard** – early authoring system of linked "cards", ancestor of today's web pages
- **CD-ROM & Laser-disc** – large-capacity media that enabled full-motion video CALL in the 1980s-90s
- **Bulletin boards & E-mail** – first CMC modes; give authentic written interaction and delayed reflection
- **Commercial quiz software (Respondus, Perception)** – auto-marked drills that motivate & free teacher time
- **MS Word** – spell/grammar check, comments, templates for materials authoring

Compilation

- **ProWritingAid / Voki / Skype / MSN / PlayPosit-EdPuzzle** – focus on automated feedback, speaking avatars, synchronous chat, interactive video respectively (examples throughout module 35)
- **Search engines & databases** – corpora + concordancers for DDL (data-driven learning)
- **ICALL** – Intelligent CALL (AI-enhanced tutoring).
- **Virtual classroom** – synchronous audio-video platform fostering "social presence"
- **Avatars & avatar-based worlds** – Second Life, MMOGs, promote embodied interaction
- **Mobile / PDA** – personalised, situated practice; speech-recognition apps, QR-based tasks
- **Reading tools (5)** – online graded readers, TTS readers, vocabulary glossers, PlayPosit-clips, BookTrack Classroom sound-tracks
- **Writing prompts & plagiarism-checkers** – encourage creativity while safeguarding originality (see research & ethics units).

Plagiarism and Related Concerns

Digital content is easy to copy, so plagiarism is widespread. Tools like **Turnitin** help detect it. Teachers are encouraged to educate students on proper citation and to require pre-submission checks.

Short Note on "A la rencontre de Philippe"

A 1980s **interactive video simulation** for French learners. Learners interact with the story, make decisions, and use authentic language in context. A classic example of early **integrative CALL**.

Three Steps of Measuring Language Learning

1. **Pre-test**: To assess baseline knowledge
2. **Process analysis**: Monitor interaction during tasks
3. **Post-test or delayed test**: To measure learning gains or retention

Commercial Quiz Software

Examples include **Hot Potatoes**, **Respondus**, and **Perception**. They automate assessment, offer feedback, and support multiple-choice, gap-fill, and matching formats.

Educational Games in CALL

Games embed language learning in fun formats. They offer task-based learning, collaboration, motivation, and hidden repetition of language forms.

Three Types of Research/Action Research

1. **Primary research** (first-hand data)
2. **Secondary research** (literature-based)
3. **Action research** – classroom-based, solving real teaching problems through iterative cycles

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Three Variables in Writer's Model

CALL contexts related to writing, three key variables often considered are:

1. **Cognitive load**
2. **Feedback type**
3. **Learner control/autonomy**

SLA (Second Language Acquisition)

SLA is the study of how learners acquire a second language. It lacks a single unified theory, but includes models like behaviorism (learning through stimulus-response) and constructivism (learning through experience and negotiation of meaning).

Focus on Form

In CALL, this refers to highlighting specific grammatical structures during meaning-focused tasks (e.g., highlighting target forms or offering meaningful restatements). Research shows learners gain more when form is made salient.

Schema Theory

Schema theory explains how learners use background knowledge to process language. It is highly relevant in CALL, especially with hypertext and multimedia, which mirror the structure of mental schemata.

Mastery Learning

This model assumes most students can master content if given enough time. In CALL, it's applied through programmed instruction, repeated attempts, and feedback until mastery is reached.

Optimal Input (5 Features)

According to Krashen (and as noted by Ellis), optimal input in CALL should be:

1. Comprehensible
2. Interesting/relevant
3. Not grammatically sequenced
4. Sufficient in quantity
5. Matched to the learner's level ("learner fit")

Compilation

Constructivist Model: Collaboration & Negotiation

Learners construct knowledge through active exploration, peer collaboration, and negotiation of meaning. CALL supports this via tasks that require interaction, sharing, and co-construction of ideas (e.g., wikis, forums, projects).

Comprehensible Input: R. Ellis

R. Ellis defines input as the language learners are exposed to. For acquisition, input should be slightly beyond the learner's current level and made comprehensible through context and interaction.

Corpus Linguistics in the Classroom

CALL allows students to use corpora (e.g., COCA) and concordancers to identify usage patterns, collocations, and grammatical structures for writing, grammar, and vocabulary learning.

Context Variable in CALL

CALL materials must be adapted to learner age, culture, learning style, and goals. Tasks must fit learners' needs and abilities to be effective.

Learning CALL in Literature

This refers to using CALL tools for literature-based language learning—reading interactive texts, annotating digital stories, and analyzing literary works using concordancers or hypermedia tools.

Learning Applications in Older Eras

Older CALL used behaviorist models: programmed instruction, language labs, and mechanical drills (e.g., Pressey's machine), evolving through mainframes and DOS-based tutorials.

Frost's Behaviorism-Related Concept

Frost critiques behaviorism for emphasizing structure over meaning. He stresses that mechanical drills in CALL may lead to surface learning rather than communicative competence.

Students' & Teachers' Behavior Using Technology

Field-independent learners prefer rule-based systems; field-dependent learners thrive with guided examples. Teacher and student attitudes toward CALL vary with cognitive styles, tech familiarity, and teaching beliefs.

Pedagogical Concerns Using Computers

- Teacher training

- Suitability of tasks
- Balancing drill vs. communication
- Managing learner autonomy
- Assessing learning outcomes

Problems in Software Development for CALL

- Difficulty in modeling learning processes
- Lack of flexible authoring tools
- Technical limitations of adaptive feedback

Main Issues in Copyright & Plagiarism

- Easy copying of online materials
- Lack of awareness about proper citation
- Need for tools like Turnitin to detect plagiarism

Lack of Expertise in CALL

Many teachers lack training in using or evaluating CALL tools, which limits implementation. Effective use requires knowledge of both pedagogy and technology.

How Teachers Can Integrate Behaviorist Techniques

- Use drills with immediate feedback
- Employ programmed instruction software
- Provide rewards and track progress
- Use linear sequencing of activities

Reasons for Using Computers in Language Learning

- Flexibility and learner autonomy
- Multimedia engagement
- Consistent feedback
- Access to authentic materials
- Language practice outside class

Cyberbullying in CALL

Online CALL environments must guard against cyberbullying, especially in forums or chats. Teachers should enforce netiquette and provide monitoring tools.

Evaluation of Students via Online Software (3 Assignments)

1. **E-Quizzes** (automated scoring)
2. **Portfolios** (writing samples, peer feedback)

3. **CAT** (adaptive grammar/vocab testing)

Major Concerns in Developing CALL Models

- Integrating diverse learning theories
- Rapid tech evolution
- Scalability and access
- Pedagogical soundness across cultures

Individual Characteristics Relevant to CALL

- Age
- Language proficiency
- Computer literacy
- Learning styles
- Motivation level

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